

WEEK

5

Study Guide

Bladder & Kidney Channels

Foot-Taiyang Bladder (67 pts) · Foot-Shaoyin Kidney (27 pts)

This Week Covers:

- Bladder Meridian of Foot-Taiyang — pathway, all 5 branches, 67 points
- Kidney Meridian of Foot-Shaoyin — pathway, all 3 branches, 27 points
- Special-category points: Back-Shu series, Command, Confluent, Xi-Cleft, Yuan-Source
- Completion of the Posterior (Inner) Circuit — HT/SI + BL/KI
- Clinical pearls, trap notes, and commonly-confused point pairs

Reading: CAM 4th Ed. p.73-77 · MOA 3rd Ed. p.251-256, 331-335

Quiz: Quiz 4 (BL+KI) follows this week per course schedule

Format: Classic Edition · MOA + CAM images · Reference-only, no quiz content

Running Course — 5 Branches

1. Inner canthus -> vertex

Starts at the inner canthus (Jingming, BL1), ascends the forehead (BL2, BL3, BL4; crosses GV24 Shenting and GB15 Toulunqi) and reaches the vertex, joining the Governor Vessel at Baihui (GV20).

2. Branch: vertex -> temple

A branch leaves the vertex and runs to the temple, meeting GB7, GB8, GB9, GB10, GB11 and GB12. (Dr. Zhang: this is one of two head branches, and one of BL's 14 total cross-points shared with the GV and GB channels.)

3. Straight portion: vertex -> bladder

The straight portion enters and communicates with the brain from the vertex, emerges and bifurcates (BL10) to descend the posterior neck, runs alongside the medial border of the scapula parallel to the spine (BL11–BL17, alongside GV13/GV14), reaches the lumbar region (BL18–BL23), enters the body cavity, connects with the Kidney, and pertains to its home organ, the Bladder (BL24–BL30).

4. Branch: lumbar region -> popliteal fossa

A branch from the lumbar region descends through the gluteal region and ends in the popliteal fossa (BL40).

5. Branch: posterior neck -> little toe

The largest branch runs straight down from the posterior neck along the medial border of the scapula (BL41–BL54), through the gluteal region (meeting GB30 Huantiao), down the lateral thigh, and meets the branch from Branch 4 in the popliteal fossa. From there it descends the posterior leg (BL55–BL60), along the 5th metatarsal (BL61–BL64), to the lateral tip of the little toe (BL65–BL67), where it links with the Kidney Meridian of Foot-Shaoyin.

Trap Notes & Exam-Safe Flags

- TRAP: BL does NOT connect to the Lung. Do not confuse with LU or the Metal-element pathway — BL's internal connection is Kidney only (confirmed midterm-era trap note).

- The two parallel lines on the back (1.5 cun and 3 cun lateral to the spine) run SIMULTANEOUSLY, not as a sequential loop. Dr. Zhang confirmed in Q&A: a student asked whether the back line travels down, back up, and down again, or runs both lines at the same time — answer: "at the same time." Do not draw it as one line doubling back.

- BL has 14 cross-points total, shared with two other channels: the Governor Vessel (GV) and the Gallbladder (GB) channel, concentrated around the head. You are not expected to know each of the 14 individually — only that BL shares crossing points with GV and GB.

- BL7 (Tongtian) is NOT the vertex-joining point — that is GV20 (Baihui), which BL merely joins at the vertex.

Function Logic (per Dr. Zhang's two-rule framework)

Running-course function

Two branches cross the head/brain -> headache. Two long parallel lines run the entire back -> low back pain, calf pain, stiff leg, sciatica-type pain along the pathway.

Internal-organ function

Pertains to the Bladder -> urination disorders. Dr. Zhang notes acupuncture is particularly effective for urinary retention — cites a clinical case where a single point resolved the presentation.

Back-Shu bridge function

BL13–BL28 are the Back-Shu (transport) points for all twelve zang-fu organs, so BL is also the channel you reach for to treat any other organ system via its associated Back-Shu point (e.g., BL13 Lung, BL15 Heart, BL18 Liver, BL20 Spleen, BL21 Stomach, BL23 Kidney, BL25 Large Intestine, BL27 Small Intestine, BL28 Bladder).

Clinical Pearls

- BL40 (Weizhong): He-Sea, Command point for the back; clears summer-heat; low back pain.
- Back-Shu points (BL13–BL28): organ transport points — treat the corresponding zang-fu organ directly from the back.
- BL60 (Kunlun): called the “aspirin of acupuncture” — headache, pain anywhere along the pathway, difficult labor.
- BL67 (Zhiyin): corrects fetal malposition with moxibustion; used for labor induction.
- BL62 (Shenmai) and BL63 (Jinmen) sit close together on the lateral foot below the malleolus — BL62 is the Confluent point (opens Yang Qiao Mai); BL63 is the Xi-Cleft.

Bladder Special Points

Category	Point	Pinyin Name
Jing-Well	BL67	Zhiyin
Ying-Spring	BL66	Zutonggu
Shu-Stream	BL65	Shugu
Jing-River	BL60	Kunlun
He-Sea	BL40	Weizhong
Yuan-Source	BL64	Jinggu
Luo-Connecting	BL58	Feiyang
Xi-Cleft	BL63	Jinmen
Front-Mu (of Bladder)	CV3	Zhongji
Back-Shu (of Bladder)	BL28	Panguangshu
Command Point (back)	BL40	Weizhong

BL13–BL28 (1.5 cun lateral to spine) are the organ-transport points: each treats its corresponding organ directly. This series is unique to BL and is the key reason BL functions as a bridge to every other channel system.

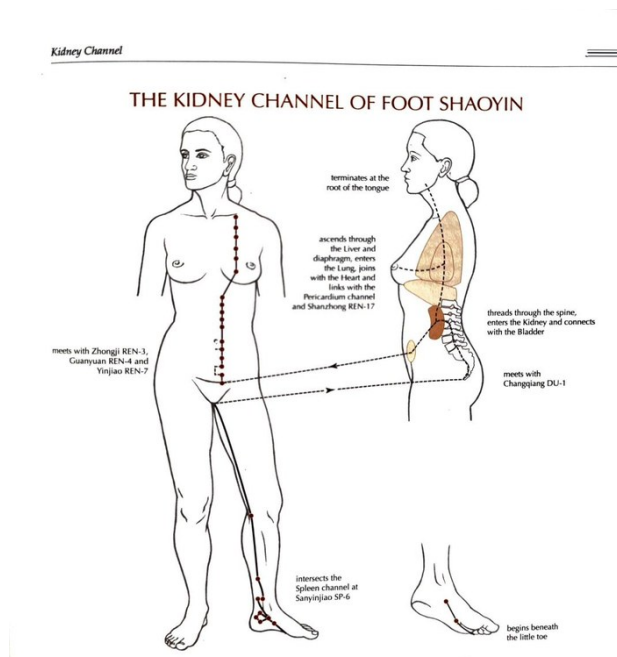
Point	Pinyin	Organ Treated
BL13	Feishu	Lung
BL14	Jueyinshu	Pericardium
BL15	Xinshu	Heart
BL18	Ganshu	Liver
BL19	Danshu	Gallbladder
BL20	Pishu	Spleen
BL21	Weishu	Stomach
BL22	Sanjiaoshu	San Jiao
BL23	Shenshu	Kidney
BL25	Dachangshu	Large Intestine
BL27	Xiaochangshu	Small Intestine
BL28	Panguangshu	Bladder

BL Point Reference — Name & Location (all 67 points)

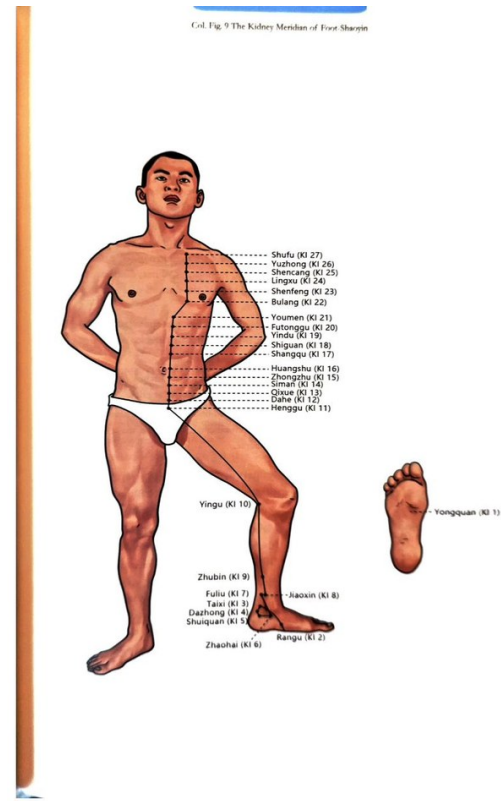
Pt	Pinyin	Location / Note	Pt	Pinyin	Location / Note
BL1	Jingming	0.1 cun superior to inner canthus	BL35	Huiyang	0.5 cun lateral to tip of coccyx
BL2	Zanzhu	Depression at medial end of eyebrow	BL36	Chengfu	Midpoint of transverse gluteal fold
BL3	Meichong	0.5 cun within hairline, above BL2	BL37	Yinmen	6 cun below BL36, on line to BL40
BL4	Quchai	0.5 cun within hairline, 1.5 cun lateral to midline	BL38	Fuxi	1 cun above BL39, medial to biceps femoris tendon
BL5	Wuchu	1 cun within hairline, 1.5 cun lateral to midline	BL39	Weiyang	Lateral end of popliteal crease — Lower He-Sea of San Jiao
BL6	Chengguang	2.5 cun within hairline, 1.5 cun lateral to midline	BL40	Weizhong	Midpoint of popliteal crease — He-Sea; Command — back
BL7	Tongtian	4 cun within hairline, 1.5 cun lateral to midline	BL41	Fufen	3 cun lat. to lower border T2 spinous process
BL8	Luoque	5.5 cun within hairline, 1.5 cun lateral to midline	BL42	Pohu	3 cun lat. to lower border T3 spinous process
BL9	Yuzhen	2.5 cun within hairline, 1.3 cun lateral to midline	BL43	Gaohuang	3 cun lat. to lower border T4 spinous process — All deficiency-taxation
BL10	Tianzhu	1.3 cun lateral to midline, within hairline	BL44	Shentang	3 cun lat. to lower border T5 spinous process
BL11	Dazhu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border T1 spinous process — Influential pt — Bone	BL45	Yixi	3 cun lat. to lower border T6 spinous process
BL12	Fengmen	1.5 cun lat. to lower border T2 spinous process	BL46	Geguan	3 cun lat. to lower border T7 spinous process
BL13	Feishu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border T3 spinous process — Back-Shu — Lung	BL47	Hunmen	3 cun lat. to lower border T9 spinous process
BL14	Jueyinshu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border T4 spinous process — Back-Shu — Pericardium	BL48	Yanggang	3 cun lat. to lower border T10 spinous process
BL15	Xinshu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border T5 spinous process — Back-Shu — Heart	BL49	Yishe	3 cun lat. to lower border T11 spinous process
BL16	Dushu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border T6 spinous process	BL50	Weicang	3 cun lat. to lower border T12 spinous process
BL17	Geshu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border T7 spinous process — Influential pt — Blood	BL51	Huangmen	3 cun lat. to lower border L1 spinous process
BL18	Ganshu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border T9 spinous process — Back-Shu — Liver	BL52	Zhishi	3 cun lat. to lower border L2 spinous process
BL19	Danshu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border T10 spinous process — Back-Shu — Gallbladder	BL53	Baohuang	3 cun lat. to lower border S2 foramen
BL20	Pishu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border T11 spinous process — Back-Shu — Spleen	BL54	Zhibian	3 cun lat. to lower border S3 foramen
BL21	Weishu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border T12 spinous process — Back-Shu — Stomach	BL55	Heyang	2 cun below BL40, on line to BL57
BL22	Sanjiaoshu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border L1 spinous process — Back-Shu — San Jiao	BL56	Chengjin	5 cun below BL40, top of gastrocnemius
BL23	Shenshu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border L2 spinous process — Back-Shu — Kidney	BL57	Chengshan	8 cun below BL40, apex of gastrocnemius — Classic for hemorrhoids
BL24	Qihai	1.5 cun lat. to lower border L3 spinous process	BL58	Feiyang	7 cun above BL60, postero-inferior to gastrocnemius — Luo-connecting
BL25	Dachangshu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border L4 spinous process — Back-Shu — Large Int.	BL59	Fuyang	3 cun directly above BL60 — Xi-Cleft of Yang Qiao Mai
BL26	Guanyuanshu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border L5 spinous process	BL60	Kunlun	Depression between lat. malleolus & Achilles tendon — Jing-River
BL27	Xiaochangshu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border S1 foramen — Back-Shu — Small Int.	BL61	Pucan	Below BL60, 4 cun inferior to lateral malleolus
BL28	Pangguangshu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border S2 foramen — Back-Shu — Bladder	BL62	Shenmai	Depression directly below lateral malleolus — Confluent — Yang Qiao Mai
BL29	Zhonglvshu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border S3 foramen	BL63	Jinmen	Anterior-inferior to BL62, lateral foot — Xi-Cleft
BL30	Baihuanshu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border S4 foramen	BL64	Jinggu	Lateral foot, antero-inferior to 5th MT tuberosity — Yuan-Source
BL31	Shangliao	1st posterior sacral foramen — Ba Liao group	BL65	Shugu	Posterior to 5th MT-phalangeal joint — Shu-Stream
BL32	Ciliao	2nd posterior sacral foramen — Ba Liao group	BL66	Zutonggu	Anterior to 5th MT-phalangeal joint — Ying-Spring
BL33	Zhongliao	3rd posterior sacral foramen — Ba Liao group	BL67	Zhiyin	Lateral side of tip of small toe — Jing-Well; last point
BL34	Xialiao	4th posterior sacral foramen — Ba Liao group			

Channel Overview

Element / Polarity:	Water · Yin
Peak Time:	5 PM – 7 PM
Pertaining Organ:	Kidney
Connecting Organ:	Bladder
Total Points:	27
First Point:	KI1 Yongquan
Last Point:	KI27 Shufu
Paired Channel:	BL
Front-Mu Point:	GB25 (Jingmen)
Back-Shu Point:	BL23 (Shenshu)



MOA 3rd Ed. primary channel figure



CAM 4th Ed. point-location figure

At a Glance

Runs foot-to-chest along the medial leg and trunk. Begins beneath the small toe, curves behind the medial malleolus and through the heel, ascends the medial thigh, threads the spine to reach its pertaining organ, then re-emerges to ascend through Liver and diaphragm into the Lung, terminating at the root of the tongue – with a branch linking into the Pericardium channel that opens Week 6.

Running Course — 3 Branches

1. Small toe -> kidney -> bladder (main pathway)

Starts beneath the small toe, runs obliquely to the sole (KI1 Yongquan), emerges below the tuberosity of the navicular bone (KI2), curves behind the medial malleolus (KI3–KI8), enters the heel, ascends the medial calf and popliteal fossa, and continues up the postero-medial thigh to the vertebral column, where it enters the Kidney (its pertaining organ) and connects with the Bladder.

2. Straight portion: kidney (re-emerging) -> root of the tongue

Re-emerges from the Kidney, ascends through the Liver and diaphragm, enters the Lung, runs along the throat, and terminates at the root of the tongue. (Dr. Zhang: Kidney is the second channel — after Spleen — to connect with the tongue root; on tongue diagnosis, the tongue root reflects Kidney function.)

3. Branch: lung -> Pericardium Meridian

A branch springs from the Lung, joins the Heart, and runs into the chest to link with the Pericardium Meridian of Hand-Jueyin — the channel that begins Week 6.

Trap Notes & Exam-Safe Flags

- CLINICAL TEACHING POINT (Dr. Zhang, verbatim emphasis): heel pain — think Kidney first. The channel curves directly behind the medial malleolus and through the heel, and this is called out explicitly as a common clinical presentation.
- KI intersects the Spleen channel at SP6 (Sanyinjiao) on the medial leg — a shared crossing point, not a KI-numbered point.
- Do not confuse KI3 (Taixi, Yuan-source AND Shu-stream — a dual role) with KI7 (Fuliu, Jing-river). Both sit near the medial malleolus/Achilles tendon: KI3 is in the depression between the malleolus tip and the Achilles tendon; KI7 is 2 cun above KI3, anterior to the Achilles tendon.
- KI6 (Zhaohai) is the Confluent point opening the Yinqiao Mai (Yin Heel Vessel) — do not mix up with KI7, which is a Jing-river (five-transport) point with a different clinical profile.

Function Logic (per Dr. Zhang's two-rule framework)

Running-course function

Pathway curves behind the medial malleolus/heel -> heel pain (Dr. Zhang's explicit clinical cue). Terminates at the tongue root -> dry mouth, sore throat, tongue-root diagnostic signs.

Internal-organ function

Kidney stores Essence (Jing) and grasps Qi (governs respiration at its root) — treats asthma-type presentations because the channel connects internally with the Lung. Also governs water metabolism, bone, marrow, and hearing.

Clinical Pearls

- KI1 (Yongquan): Jing-Well; resuscitation, calms the spirit; used in hypertension.
- KI3 (Taixi): Yuan-source; the key tonic point for Kidney Yin AND Yang.
- KI6 (Zhaohai): Confluent (Yinqiao Mai); insomnia, sore throat, irregular menstruation.
- KI7 (Fuliu): tonifies Kidney Yang; edema; night sweats (often paired with HT6).
- KI27 (Shufu): final point of the channel, inferior border of the clavicle — links functionally into the chest before the Pericardium channel begins.

Kidney Special Points

Category	Point	Pinyin Name
Jing-Well	KI1	Yongquan
Ying-Spring	KI2	Rangu
Shu-Stream	KI3	Taixi
Jing-River	KI7	Fulu
He-Sea	KI10	Yingu
Yuan-Source	KI3	Taixi
Luo-Connecting	KI4	Dazhong
Xi-Cleft	KI5	Shuiquan
Front-Mu (of Kidney)	GB25	Jingmen
Back-Shu (of Kidney)	BL23	Shenshu
Confluent (opens Yinqiao Mai)	KI6	Zhaohai

KI Point Reference — Name & Location (all 27 points)

Pt	Pinyin	Location / Note	Pt	Pinyin	Location / Note
KI1	Yongquan	Sole of foot, depression when plantar-flexed — Jing-Well; first point	KI15	Zhongzhu	1 cun below navel, 0.5 cun lateral to midline
KI2	Rangu	Below tuberosity of navicular bone — Ying-Spring	KI16	Huangshu	Level with navel, 0.5 cun lateral to midline
KI3	Taixi	Depression between medial malleolus tip & Achilles tendon — Shu-Stream; Yuan-Source	KI17	Shangqu	2 cun above navel, 0.5 cun lateral to midline
KI4	Dazhong	0.5 cun posterior to KI3, medial calcaneus — Luo-connecting	KI18	Shiguan	3 cun above navel, 0.5 cun lateral to midline
KI5	Shuiquan	1 cun below KI3, antero-superior to calcaneal tuberosity — Xi-Cleft	KI19	Yindu	4 cun above navel, 0.5 cun lateral to midline
KI6	Zhaohai	1 cun below tip of medial malleolus — Confluent — Yinqiao Mai	KI20	Futonggu	5 cun above navel, 0.5 cun lateral to midline
KI7	Fulu	2 cun above KI3, anterior to Achilles tendon — Jing-River	KI21	Youmen	6 cun above navel, 0.5 cun lateral to midline
KI8	Jiaoxin	2 cun above KI3, posterior to KI7 — Xi-Cleft of Yinqiao Mai	KI22	Bulang	5th ICS, 2 cun lateral to midline
KI9	Zhubin	5 cun above KI3, medial gastrocnemius head — Xi-Cleft of Yinwei Mai	KI23	Shenfeng	4th ICS, 2 cun lateral to midline
KI10	Yingu	Medial end of popliteal crease — He-Sea	KI24	Lingxu	3rd ICS, 2 cun lateral to midline
KI11	Henggu	5 cun below navel, 0.5 cun lateral to midline	KI25	Shencang	2nd ICS, 2 cun lateral to midline
KI12	Dahe	4 cun below navel, 0.5 cun lateral to midline	KI26	Yuzhong	1st ICS, 2 cun lateral to midline
KI13	Qixue	3 cun below navel, 0.5 cun lateral to midline	KI27	Shufu	Inferior border of clavicle, 2 cun lateral to midline — Last point
KI14	Siman	2 cun below navel, 0.5 cun lateral to midline			

BL60 vs BL62/BL63

BL60 Kunlun (Jing-River, mid-Achilles) sits above BL62 Shenmai (Confluent, directly below malleolus) and BL63 Jinmen (Xi-Cleft, anterior-inferior to BL62). All three cluster around the lateral ankle — map them from the malleolus outward.

KI3 vs KI7

KI3 Taixi = Shu-Stream + Yuan-Source, in the malleolus/Achilles depression. KI7 Fuliu = Jing-River, 2 cun proximal to KI3, anterior to the Achilles tendon.

KI6 vs KI7

KI6 Zhaohai (Confluent, Yinqiao Mai, below the malleolus) is functionally distinct from KI7 Fuliu (Jing-River, tonifies Yang) despite being nearby.

BL40 vs BL54 vs BL57

All are leg/thigh points on the same posterior line: BL40 Weizhong (popliteal crease, He-Sea/Command) -> BL54 Zhibian (upper thigh/sacrum) -> BL57 Chengshan (calf belly, 8 cun below BL40). Sequence matters for the running-course quiz format.

Posterior Circuit — Course Milestone

Week 5 completes the Posterior Circuit (also called Inner Circuit on earlier slide versions): HT and SI (Week 4) plus BL and KI (this week) form the full four-channel posterior/inner circuit. Dr. Zhang's own framing at the end of Lecture 5: "until now, we have learned the posterior circuit, and four meridians consist of the posterior circuit."